

BALANZONI

REST

45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

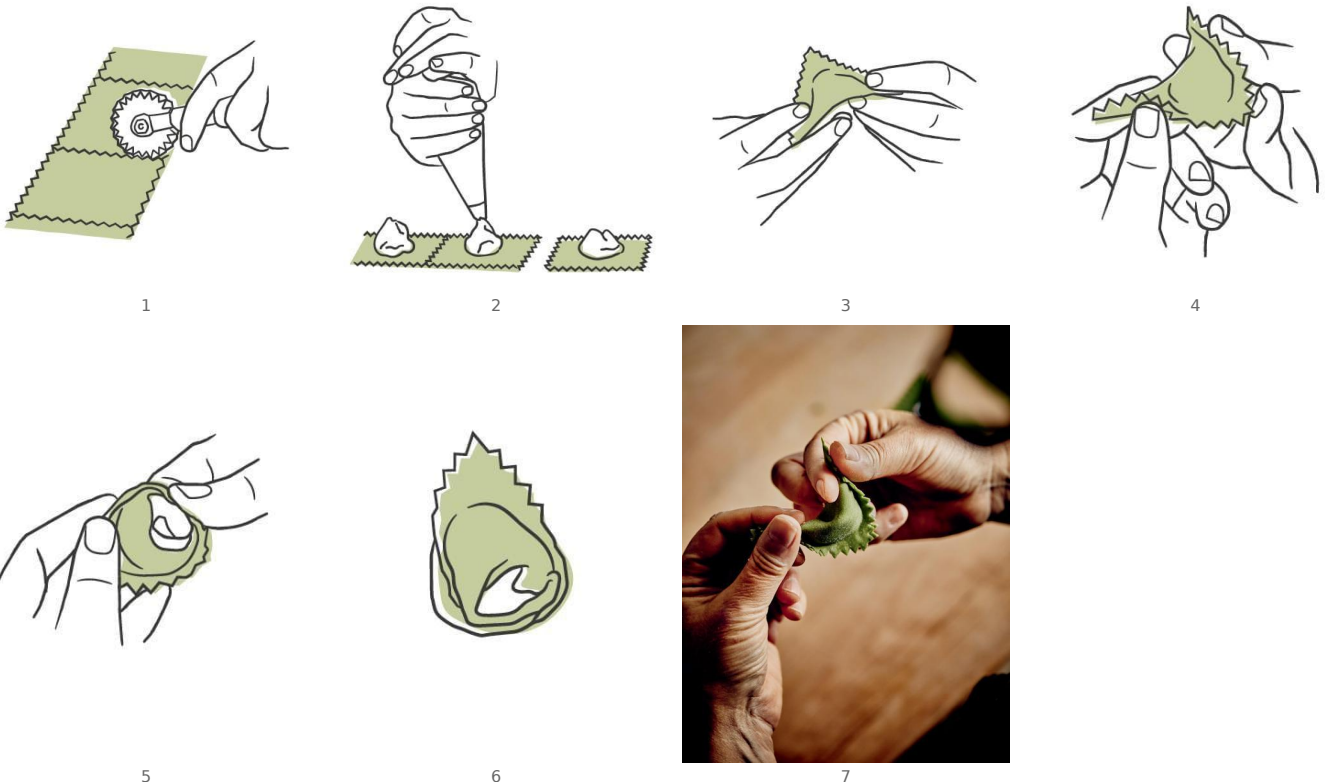
DETAILS

- Region: Emilia-Romagna, city of Bologna

METHOD

1. Make the green dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Cut one sheet into 2 1/2-inch squares with a plain-edged or fluted dough divider. A plain or fluted pastry cutter with a ruler, or a knife with a ruler, does the same job. Keep the squares under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/2-inch opening. Pipe a quarter-sized circle of filling into the middle of each square.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the squares with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the seal will hold. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a square in your palm and bring one corner across to its opposite, edges aligned, making a triangle.
7. Pinch the edge shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Press a dimple into the center of the filled side with your index finger.
9. Hold the two bottom points of the triangle and bring them together underneath the filling to form a wide ring, leaving a gap between filling and closure. Pinch that joint tight, then flatten it to roughly the thickness of the rest of the piece so it cooks evenly.
10. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the squares, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
11. Work through the remainder of the sheet, then the rest of the sheets.
12. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Sheet is cut into 2 1/2-inch squares, one piece per square.

Filling per piece: a quarter-sized circle, piped through a 1/2-inch pastry-bag opening.

Cutter: plain-edged or fluted dough divider.

Seal geometry: fold to a triangle, pinch the edge closed, dimple the filled side, then join the two bottom points beneath the filling into a wide ring. The book specifies a gap between filling and closure, where tortellini are drawn tight against the filling.

Air must be forced out of the edge as you pinch, and the finished joint gets flattened to the thickness of the rest of the piece for even cooking.

Needs the green (spinach) egg dough rather than a plain egg dough.

Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.

Served with a simple butter-based sauce. The classic Bolognese treatment is butter, sage, and parmigiano.

DOUGH

Green Dough

Makes: 998 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading, plus blanching / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

454 g, to yield 250 g puree	Spinach leaves
630 g	Tipo 00 flour
118 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading

METHOD

1. Blanch the spinach 30 seconds to 1 minute, until tender but still bright green, then straight into ice water.
2. Drain, wrap in a towel and wring out every bit of water. This matters, since leftover water throws the hydration.
3. Blend to a smooth puree, loosening with a tablespoon of water at a time if it will not move.
4. Measure out 250 g of puree. Freeze the excess.
5. Mix the yolks lightly, then stir the puree through them.
6. Mound the flour with a well 5 to 6 inches across, add half the green mixture, drawing in flour with a fork.
7. Add the rest the same way, scraping back any escapes.
8. Knead 8 to 10 minutes until smooth, firm, evenly bright green, with a slight spring back.
9. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes.

NOTES

454 g of leaves cooks down to more than 250 g, so you will have overage. Weigh the puree rather than using all of it.

118 g of yolks is about 6 to 7 eggs, far fewer than plain egg dough, because the puree carries much of the liquid.

For ramp dough, swap half the spinach for leafy ramp tops.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

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